

150 Financial Analyst Team

Description & Eligibility

Teams will apply accounting and financial analysis principles to prepare and interpret statements, evaluate performance, and communicate insights for informed business decision-making. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. At least one (1) contestant should have an accounting background. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

Lifted Technologies is a startup developing AI-powered diagnostic tools for rural healthcare providers. The company offers a subscription-based software platform (SaaS) and specialized medical scanning equipment to clinics underserved by traditional healthcare infrastructure.

After three years of operations, *Lifted Technologies* has gained a strong client base in the Midwest and Southeast and is now seeking Series B funding to scale nationally. The company carries significant investment in patents and equipment as it continues to invest heavily in research and development. Leadership must now decide between pursuing venture capital funding, securing a bank loan, or entering a strategic partnership with a larger healthcare company to finance their national expansion.

Below is the financial data for the first two years of operations:

Accounts	2025	2026
Accounts Payable	\$54,000	\$76,000
Accounts Receivable	76,000	124,000
Accrued Liabilities	38,000	52,000
Cash	18,500	44,600
Common Stock	240,000	360,000
Cost of Goods Sold	312,000	446,400
Deferred Revenue	22,000	36,000
Equipment, net	330,000	400,000
Intangible Assets (Patents), net	160,000	220,000
Interest Expense	28,000	24,000
Inventory	96,000	122,000
Mortgage Payable	100,000	85,000
Notes Payable	180,000	155,000
Operating Expenses	96,000	118,000
Prepaid Expenses	9,500	19,000
Research & Development	48,000	72,000
Retained Earnings	56,000	145,600
Revenues	540,000	750,000

Tasks:

1. Financial Analysis
 - a. Prepare financial statements for 2025 and 2026
 - b. Calculate liquidity, debt, and profitability ratios
 - c. Complete a horizontal and vertical analysis

2. Based on this financial analysis, evaluate Lifted Technologies' financial health and recommend which funding strategy (venture capital, bank loan, or strategic partnership) best positions the company for national expansion. Create a presentation to justify your recommendation using the data from the financial statements.

Team Must Supply

- One (1) copy of the Works Cited, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form for each round (prelims and finals)
- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- Sharpened pencils, pens, ruler
- Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be *disqualified*.
- Optional Items
 - Easel, posters, graphs, poster board and/or flipcharts and markers and external displays will not be provided or permitted.
 - Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team and must take place within the allotted time for orientation/warm-up
- Business Professionals of America assumes no responsibility for hardware/software provided by the contestant
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes setup in presentation room, no more than ten (10) minutes presentation time, no more than ten (10) minutes of judges' questions
 - No more than five (5) minutes proctor orientation for state and national levels
 - No more than thirty (30) minutes preparation time for state and national levels
- Finals may be required at state and national levels
 - Teams will be presented with an additional element to the scenario that requires revision of their final presentation
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Contest Competencies

1. Apply accounting principles to evaluate and report the value of assets, liabilities, and owner's equity in accordance with GAAP
2. Prepare, interpret, and analyze financial statements to assess performance and support strategic decision-making across various business models
3. Apply planning and control principles, including budgeting, forecasting, differential analysis, and present-value concepts, to evaluate organizational performance and guide financial decisions for both the short and long-term
4. Evaluate credit options, costs, and legal implications, and identify financial risks to inform business decisions and develop mitigation strategies
5. Communicate financial insights clearly, courteously, and professionally to diverse stakeholders
6. Use ratio analysis to evaluate comparative financial statements and assess organizational trends and performance
7. Apply statistical procedures and utilize spreadsheet software to analyze, interpret, and model financial data efficiently and accurately
8. Present financial findings using formal presentations and supporting materials to communicate insights and recommendations effectively

Contest Specifications for this Event

- At state and national levels, teams will be given an additional element in addition to the original scenario to address during the final round presentation. This added element is specific to the level of competition and is not connected to or carried over from previous competition.
- No personal electronic devices (smart watches, smart glasses, cell phone, etc.) other than the laptop, notebook, or tablet approved for the presentation.
- No advisor contact will be allowed between the time of receiving the additional element and the delivery of the presentation.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestant(s) will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. (Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*).
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level.

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/50
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
*Inclusion of On-Site Information	Did not incorporate additional information or made minimal adjustments.	Made appropriate adjustments based on the additional information.	Fully integrated the additional information with insightful adjustments.	/20
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/125

*NOTE: This item will only be evaluated at state and national level round competitions.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES